

markdown2html5-base

Full Markdown Functionality Reference

This reference covers all `markdown2html5-base` features.

Table of Contents

- [Programmatic Usage](#)
- [1. Headings \(H1-H6\)](#)
- [2. Inline Text Styling](#)
- [3. Links and Images](#)
- [4. Fenced Code Blocks](#)
- [5. Horizontal Rules](#)
- [6. Lists](#)
- [7. Blockquotes](#)
- [8. Tables](#)
- [9. Definition Lists](#)
- [10. Footnotes](#)
- [11. Language Markers](#)
- [12. Ruby Annotations](#)
- [13. Emoji Shortcodes](#)
- [14. Typography and Legal Marks](#)
- [15. Hard Line Breaks](#)
- [16. HTML Comments](#)
- [17. YAML Front Matter](#)
- [18. Backslash Escaping](#)
- [19. Paragraphs](#)
- [20. CSS Styles](#)

Programmatic Usage

```
from markdown2html5_base import MarkdownToHTML
converter = MarkdownToHTML()
html = converter.convert("# Hello")
print(html)
```

1. Headings (H1-H6)

Markdown	Output HTML
# Heading 1	Heading 1
## Heading 2	Heading 2
### Heading 3	Heading 3
#### Heading 4	Heading 4
##### Heading 5	Heading 5
##### Heading 6	Heading 6

Custom ID: ## Section {#sec1} => <h2 id="sec1">Section</h2>

2. Inline Text Styling

Markdown	Output HTML
bold italic	bold italic
___bold italic___	bold italic
bold	bold
__bold__	bold
italic	italic
italic	italic
~~strikethrough~~	<s>strikethrough</s>
==highlight==	<mark>highlight</mark>
~subscript~	_{subscript}
^^underline^^	<u>underline</u>
^superscript^	^{superscript}
`code`	<code>code</code>

3. Links and Images

Markdown	Output HTML
[text](url)	text
![alt](src)	<figure></figure>
![alt](src "Title")	<figure> <figcaption>Title</figcaption></figure>

4. Fenced Code Blocks

A language tag after the opening fence (three backticks before and after the code) is rendered as a `<div class="code-lang">/python/</div>` label above the `<code>` element:

```
<div class="code-lang">&sol;python&sol;</div><pre><code>def hello():
    print("Hi")</code></pre>
```

Without a language tag, the code renders plainly as `<pre><code>`.

5. Horizontal Rules

`---` / `***` / `___` (3+ chars) => `<hr>`

6. Lists

- 1. **Unordered:** `* Item` or `- Item` => `<ul><li>Item</li></ul>`
- 2. **Ordered:** `1. Item` => `<ol><li>Item</li></ol>`
- 3. **Task:**
 - `* [ ] todo` => `<li><input type="checkbox" disabled> todo</li>`
 - `* [x] done` => `<li><input type="checkbox" checked disabled> done</li>`

7. Blockquotes

`> text` => `<blockquote><p>text</p></blockquote>` : blank lines within a blockquote split into separate `<p>` tags.

8. Tables

Supports `<thead>`, `<tbody>`, `<tfoot>`, and alignment:

Separator	Alignment
<code>:---</code>	left
<code>:---:</code>	center
<code>---:</code>	right

Footer: a row of `=` signs below the separator columns, after the body rows, renders a `<tfoot>`.

```
| Product | Qty | Price |
| :----- | :-: | ----: |
| Apples  | 2   | $3.00 |
| Bananas | 3   | $1.50 |
| Cherries| 1   | $4.00 |
|=====|=====|=====|
| Total   | 6   | $8.50 |
```

=>

```

<table>
  <thead>
    <tr>
      <th style="text-align:left;">Product</th>
      <th style="text-align:center;">Qty</th>
      <th style="text-align:right;">Price</th>
    </tr>
  </thead>
  <tbody>
    <tr>
      <td style="text-align:left;">Apples</td>
      <td style="text-align:center;">2</td>
      <td style="text-align:right;">$3.00</td>
    </tr>
    <tr>
      <td style="text-align:left;">Bananas</td>
      <td style="text-align:center;">3</td>
      <td style="text-align:right;">$1.50</td>
    </tr>
    <tr>
      <td style="text-align:left;">Cherries</td>
      <td style="text-align:center;">1</td>
      <td style="text-align:right;">$4.00</td>
    </tr>
  </tbody>
  <tfoot>
    <tr>
      <td style="text-align:left;">Total</td>
      <td style="text-align:center;">6</td>
      <td style="text-align:right;">$8.50</td>
    </tr>
  </tfoot>
</table>

```

9. Definition Lists

```

Term
: Definition 1
: Definition 2

```

=>

```

<dl>
  <dt>Term</dt>
  <dd>Definition 1</dd>
  <dd>Definition 2</dd>
</dl>

```

10. Footnotes

Reference: `[^1]` => `<sup id="fnref:1"><a href="#fn:1" class="footnote-ref">1</a></sup>`

Definition: `[^1]: Text` at bottom => rendered in `<div class="footnotes"><ol>...</ol></div>`

11. Language Markers

Annotate blocks or inline text with a language using a valid BCP 47 tag (e.g. `de`, `fr`, `zh-Hans`).

- **Block level:** Place `{:lang}` (with a space after it) at the very start of a line, before the Markdown tag. It renders as the global `lang` attribute on the resulting element and needs no closing marker:

```
{:de} # Überschrift
{:fr} Un paragraphe français.
{:ru} - Пункт списка
{:de} > Ein Zitat
{:de} | Kopf | Kopf |
      | ----- | ----- |
      | Zelle | Zelle |
```

=>

```
<h1 lang="de">Überschrift</h1>
<p lang="fr">Un paragraphe français.</p>
<ul lang="ru">
  <li>Пункт списка</li>
</ul>
<blockquote lang="de">...</blockquote>
<table lang="de">...</table>
```

- **Inline level:** Wrap text with `{:lang}...{:}` to render a `<span lang="...">`:

A French phrase `{:fr}"L'État c'est moi"{:}` is traditionally attributed to King Louis XIV of France.

=>

```
<p>A French phrase <span lang="fr">"L'État c'est moi"</span> is traditionally attributed to King
Louis XIV of France</p>
```

12. Ruby Annotations

`{日本語|にほんご}` => `<ruby>日本語<rp>(</rp><rt>にほんご</rt><rp>)</rp></ruby>`

13. Emoji Shortcodes

- `:joy:` 😄
- `:smile:` 😊

- `:heart:` ❤️
- `:thumbsup:` 👍
- `:thumbsdown:` 👎
- `:wink:` 😉
- `:tada:` 🎉
- `:rocket:` 🚀
- `:fire:` 🔥
- `:star:` ★
- `:cry:` 😭
- `:thinking:` 🤔
- `:100:` 100
- `:sparkles:` ✨
- `:eyes:` 👁️
- `:bulb:` 💡
- `:warning:` ⚠️
- `:ok:` 🏆
- `:check_mark:` ✓

14. Typography and Legal Marks

Name	Input	HTML Output
Copyright	(c)	©
Trademark	(tm)	™
Registered Trademark	(r)	®
Plus-Minus	+/-	±
Not Equal To	!=	≠
Logical Equivalence	<=>	⇔
Less-Than or Equal To	<=	≤
Greater-Than or Equal To	>=	≥
Right Arrow	->	→
Left Arrow	<-	←
Up Arrow	↑	↑
Down Arrow	↓	↓
Logical Implication	=>	⇒
Solidus (Slash)	/	/
Reverse Solidus (Backslash)	\	\
One-Half	1/2	½
One-Third	1/3	⅓
Two-Thirds	2/3	⅔
One-Quarter	1/4	¼
Three-Quarters	3/4	¾
Left Angle Quote	<<	«
Right Angle Quote	>>	»
Left Double Quote	“	“
Right Double Quote	”	”
Smart Double Quotes	"text"	“text”
Smart Single Quotes	'text'	‘text’
Straight Apostrophe	'	'
Em Dash	---	—
En Dash	--	–
Ellipsis	...	…
Non-Breaking Space	 	

15. Hard Line Breaks

End line with two spaces or backslash: `<br />`

16. HTML Comments

`[comment]: # => <!--comment-->`

17. YAML Front Matter

If the file begins with a YAML front matter block between `---` lines, the converter emits a complete HTML5 document with the metadata in `<head>` and the body content between `<body>` tags. Without front matter, the output stays a bare HTML fragment. The `--css` option (or `include_css=True`) embeds the default `<style>` block regardless of whether front matter is present.

```
---
lang: en
title: My Document
author: Jane Doe
description: A short description.
keywords: python, markdown, html5
published: 2026-08-09
---
```

- `lang` becomes the `<html lang="...">` attribute (a valid BCP 47 tag).
- `title` becomes the `<title>` element.
- `author`, `description`, `keywords`, and `published` become `<meta name="..." content="..." />` tags.
- A default `<style>` block with viewing-friendly CSS is embedded in `<head>`.

```
<!doctype html>
<html lang="en">
  <head>
    <meta charset="utf-8" />
    <meta name="author" content="Jane Doe" />
    <meta name="description" content="A short description." />
    <meta name="keywords" content="python, markdown, html5" />
    <title>My Document</title>
    <meta name="published" content="2026-08-09" />
    <style>
      /* default viewing-friendly CSS */
    </style>
  </head>
  <body>
    ...
  </body>
</html>
```

Any other keys are ignored, and if the file has no front matter at all, the output remains a bare fragment (unless `--css / include_css=True` is used, in which case it becomes a full document).

18. Backslash Escaping

Escape any special char: `\*`, `\#`, `\[`, etc.

Escapable: `\`*_{}[]()#+-.!|~^=:<>`

19. Paragraphs

Consecutive text lines merge into `<p>`. Blank lines separate paragraphs.

Empty line after list close => `<!-- -->` preserves whitespace.

20. CSS Styles

The converter (with `--css` option or `include_css=True`) embeds a default `<style>` block in `<head>` that provides viewing-friendly styling, regardless of YAML front matter. This predefined CSS rules includes:

```
body {
  padding: 20px;
  font-family:
    "Noto Serif",
    "Liberation Serif",
    "Times New Roman",
    Times,
    serif;
  font-size: 18px;
  line-height: 1.4;
  color: #000000;
}
h1, h2, h3, h4, h5, h6 {
  margin-top: 1.2em;
  margin-bottom: 0.6em;
  font-family:
    "Noto Sans",
    "Liberation Sans",
    Arial,
    sans-serif;
  font-weight: bold;
}
h1 { font-size: 32px; }
h2 { font-size: 28px; }
h3 { font-size: 24px; }
h4 { font-size: 20px; }
h5 { font-size: 18px; }
h6 {
  font-size: 18px;
  font-style: italic;
}
hr {
  height: 4px;
  margin: 20px 0;
  border: none;
  background-color: #000000;
}
li {
  position: relative;
  padding-left: 20px;
}
dt { font-weight: bold; }
dd {
  position: relative;
  margin-left: 0;
  padding-left: 20px;
  font-style: italic;
}
blockquote {
  margin-left: 0;
  padding-left: 20px;
  border-left: 8px solid #f5f5f5;
}
```

```

}
mark {
  padding: 0 2px;
  border-radius: 4px;
  background-color: #ffff00;
}
a:link { color: #0000cd; }
a:visited { color: #9400d3; }
a:hover, a:focus {
  outline: none;
  color: #000080;
}
a:active { color: #dc143c; }
code {
  padding: 2px 4px;
  border-radius: 4px;
  font-family:
    "Noto Sans Mono",
    "Liberation Mono",
    "Courier New",
    Courier,
    monospace;
  font-size: 0.9em;
  line-height: 1;
}
pre {
  max-width: 100%;
  margin: 0;
  padding: 20px;
  border: 1px solid #000000;
  background-color: #f5f5f5;
  overflow: auto;
  scrollbar-color: #000000 transparent;
}
pre > code {
  display: block;
  margin: 0;
  padding: 0;
  border: none;
  border-radius: 0;
  line-height: 1.2;
  background-color: transparent;
  overflow: visible;
}
div.code-lang {
  display: block;
  padding: 10px 20px;
  font-family:
    "Noto Sans Mono",
    "Liberation Mono",
    "Courier New",
    Courier,
    monospace;

```

```

    font-size: 0.9em;
    line-height: 1;
    background-color: #000000;
    color: #ffffff;
    font-weight: bold;
}
table {
    margin: 20px 0;
    border-collapse: collapse;
}
th, td {
    padding: 10px 12px;
    border: 1px solid #000000;
}
th { font-weight: bold; }
thead tr {
    background-color: #000000;
    color: #ffffff;
}
tfoot tr {
    background-color: #f5f5f5;
    font-style: italic;
}
figure {
    display: block;
    margin: 0;
}
figure img {
    display: block;
    max-width: 100%;
    height: auto;
}
figcaption {
    text-align: left;
    font-style: italic;
}
ruby { ruby-position: over; }
rt {
    letter-spacing: 0.05em;
    font-size: 0.55em;
    line-break: strict;
}
rp { display: none; }
span[lang="ja"] {
    font-family:
        "Noto Serif CJK JP",
        "Source Han Serif JP",
        "源ノ明朝",
        "Source Han Serif",
        "Hiragino Mincho ProN",
        "Hiragino Mincho Pro",
        "IPAexMincho",
        "IPAMincho",

```

```
    "MS PMincho",
    "MS Mincho",
    serif;
}
span[lang="zh-CN"], span[lang="zh-Hans"] {
    font-family:
        "Noto Serif CJK SC",
        "Source Han Serif SC",
        "思源宋体",
        "Source Han Serif CN",
        "Source Han Serif",
        "Songti SC",
        "FandolSong",
        "WenQuanYi Bitmap Song",
        "SimSun",
    serif;
}
span[lang="zh-TW"], span[lang="zh-Hant"] {
    font-family:
        "Noto Serif CJK TC",
        "Source Han Serif TC",
        "思源宋體",
        "Source Han Serif TW",
        "Source Han Serif",
        "Apple LiSung",
        "LiSong Pro",
        "HanaMinA",
        "PMingLiU",
        "MingLiU",
    serif;
}
span[lang="zh-HK"] {
    font-family:
        "Noto Serif CJK HK",
        "Source Han Serif HK",
        "思源宋體 香港",
        "思源宋體",
        "Source Han Serif",
        "Apple LiSung",
        "LiSong Pro",
        "HanaMinA",
        "MingLiU_HKSCS",
        "PMingLiU",
        "MingLiU",
    serif;
}
span[lang="ko"] {
    font-family:
        "Noto Serif CJK KR",
        "Source Han Serif KR",
        "본명조",
        "Source Han Serif",
        "AppleMyungjo",

```

```
"UnBatang",  
"은바탕",  
"Batang",  
serif;
```

```
}
```